

Note: If a reduction for a short submission has to be made, this is done at the *very end* of the marking process after the averaging of marks for the various pieces.

1.4 How the assessment criteria will be applied

1 Choosing the correct assessment criteria

Students may present pieces played or sung from a score and/or improvised performances. Each piece should be marked according to the appropriate set of assessment criteria. The first set of criteria, in *Section 1.5*, is used to assess performances of pieces from a score. The second set, in *Section 1.6*, is for improvised performances.

2 Marking procedure

The assessment criteria must be applied separately for each piece. (Please note that if two or more movements from a sonata or suite are offered, each movement is a separate piece for marking purposes.)

For each piece, use the holistic assessment criterion (out of 40) to give an overall reflection of the performance of the piece and then use all five detailed assessment criteria (each out of eight) to report on specific aspects of technique and expression. Then reconcile the totals arrived at by these different routes.

For example, you may choose a holistic mark of 25 out of 40. Then you will identify suitable marks for the five detailed assessment criteria, each out of eight. If these up add to 25 (eg $5 + 5 + 6 + 4 + 5$), 25 is clearly the final mark out of 40 for the piece. If, however, there is a discrepancy eg detailed marking gives $5 + 6 + 6 + 5 + 5 = 27$ while holistic marking suggests 25, briefly revisit both the detailed and the holistic assessment criterion until a single mark (which need not be the average of 25 and 27) is selected. If 27 seems over-generous, and the holistic mark of 25 more appropriate award the single mark of 25/40.

Once you have arrived at a mark out of 40, you should scale the mark according to the difficulty of the piece performed (see the performance grid on page 37). If a student performs a Grade 5 piece, the mark will stay the same. However, if a student is awarded 25 out of 40 and played pieces that were Grade 7 in terms of level of difficulty, the final scaled mark will be 28/40.

When you have marked and scaled each piece out of 40, calculate the average to produce a single mark out of 40. For example, if there are four pieces and they are awarded 30, 32, 38 and 28, the final mark is $30 + 32 + 38 + 28 \div 4 = 32$. Decimals of 0.5 or greater must be rounded up to the next whole number. Decimals smaller than 0.5 must be rounded down.